

Tom de Gay

tomdegay.com →
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Product design leader
14 years in hands-on product design
Design for AI and automation

Profile

Product design leader specialising in AI, automation and complex domains. With a background in wayfinding, I make technically ambitious systems clear and usable. A founding-team member at Quantemplate, I remain hands-on across strategy, research, interaction design and delivery.

Experience

Quantemplate

Enterprise data platform for sharing, transforming, validating and automating complex commercial data in a no-code environment. Trusted by AXA, Aegon, Chubb, Everest, Somo and more, supporting 17,000 pipeline runs and outputting 3.4 billion rows annually. The business has developed through several phases with different focuses, objectives and stakeholders.

Head of Design | Product Leadership

2021–Present

Expanded remit into product leadership, shaping strategy and direction while leading the end-to-end product experience as an individual contributor whilst business refocused on product R&D.

- Designed a semantic layer that improved usability and performance across the product, including a fourfold improvement in the accuracy of column-mapping suggestions.
- Proposed and delivered Feeds, a strategic initiative connecting organisations to share data and build network intelligence.
- Designed the automation framework and ‘Robot User’ concept, laying the groundwork for agentic capabilities.
- Worked directly with customers on implementations and product improvements. Mature implementations now average just three support requests per year.
- Introduced AI prototyping tools into the design process, shortening product feedback loops.
- Supported enterprise procurement through technical and design RFP responses.

Head of Design

2016–21

Led design through the company’s pivot to data transformation, from seed through Series A from leading Silicon Valley investors. Business grew to serve clients in USA, UK and Europe.

- Designed the data transformation product experience across 30+ distinct functions.
- Established ease of use as a key differentiator for blue-chip insurance clients.
- Hired and managed four people across design and marketing.
- Extended an externally developed brand identity and rolled it out across all channels.
- Migrated design tooling and established a scalable engineering-friendly design system.
- Created the product knowledge base (100+ articles), allowing users to self-serve.

Founding Product Designer

2012–16

Joined a four-person team as first designer, exploring fintech and insurtech ideas.

- Designed the product experience and in-product brand, making complex analytics accessible through drag-and-drop dashboards, multi-page reports and data visualisation. Established ease of use and a distinctive product identity as early differentiators.
- Joined Techstars’ first London cohort in 2013 and subsequently secured seed funding.

Experience

Placefield | Independent design consultancy

2012–Present

Placefield is my independent design practice for selected side-projects, providing space to explore new tools and ideas. Digital projects include:

- Image Insight (2026). Digital coaching tool. Turned a 'clunky' MVP into an elegant, low-friction experience with positive user feedback. Currently in beta testing in two schools.
- Zonefully (2021). A new model for planning recurring activities around long-term goals. Translated the founder's model into a coherent interface, bringing the concept from idea to a resolved and functioning v1.

Avanti Architects | Wayfinding designer

2005–12

- Design lead on wayfinding projects spanning strategy, information design and environmental graphics.
- Projects included audit, strategy, planning and execution for complex sites such as Bristol Southmead Hospital (600k visitors/year), Pontefract Hospital (100k visitors/year) and Haggerston School (1,100 pupils).
- Wayfinding principles continue to underpin my digital product practice today.

Leeds Beckett University | Visiting Lecturer

2005–16

- Teaching, mentoring and opening up possibilities for around 300 final-year students in Graphic Design, Fine Art and contemporary Art Practices.

Education

MA Communication Design | Distinction

2003–05 | Central Saint Martins College of Art & Design

Specialised in information design and wayfinding, exploring how design helps people understand and navigate complex environments.

BA (Hons) Graphic Arts and Design | First Class

2000–03 | Leeds Beckett University

Additional Roles

Design for Complexity Meetup | Co-Founder

2018–20

Meetup for people involved in the design of complex products. Grew membership to 500 and ran several in-person events with insightful talks from industry leaders.

Isokon Gallery | Trustee | Design Lead

2014–Present

Co-founded and designed award-winning micro museum in London, dedicated to the story of modernist architecture, design and urban living. 50k visitors and counting.

Expertise

Skills

Product design · Interaction design · Information architecture · Prototyping · Design systems · Data visualisation · Enterprise UX · Zero-to-one

Domains

Design for AI · Complex systems · Enterprise SaaS · Data products · Workflow automation · Analytics · Insurance technology

Tools

Claude Code · Figma · Sketch · Lovable · After Effects · Adobe Creative Suite · Miro · GitHub · HTML/CSS